Final Section.—The final entries are somewhat irregular, that in bar 39 being uncompleted, while that in bar 40 is still more altered, having lost the characteristic arpeggio of its commencement.

There are four episodes. The first (bars 5 to 10) is inverted to form the third (bars 24 to 29), and the second (bars 15 to 19), to form the fourth (bars 34 to 38). The occurrence of unison passages (bars 19 and 38) is extremely rare in a fugue.

FUGUE II

F MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

Exposition.—The subject, which is announced in the alto, consists of a rhythmical phrase of four bars:—



As this begins on the dominant, the answer, in the treble, is **tonal.** beginning on the tonic. The countersubject commences on the first semiquaver of bar 5, with the second note of the answer, After a bar of codetta, the bass enters with the subject (bar 9, third beat), the countersubject being given to the treble.

Counter-Exposition.—After a short episode founded on the countersubject in the bass, with new counterpoint above it, there is a complete counter-exposition (bar 17, third beat, to bar 31, first beat). In this the order of entry is: subject in treble; answer in alto; subject in bass, with a redundant entry of subject in alto, two bars after the bass, and therefore producing the first stretto. The countersubject is transferred from alto to bass in bars 18, 19, has

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 32-33.
BWV 856. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

its first three notes in inverse movement in bar 26 (treble) and is incomplete in bars 29 to 31 (bass).

Middle Section.—The middle section commences in bar 31, with a second episode, which is founded on the third bar of the subject in the upper parts, with a free bass. The appearances of the subject in this section are in stretto, and are very orderly. Bars 36 to 44 are in D minor, the stretto in the octave at two bars' distance, all the voices participating, beginning with the highest; bars 46 to 54 in G minor, the stretto at the same interval of pitch and of time, but beginning with the **lowest** voice. To each stretto is added a codetta of two bars ending with a perfect cadence. The third episode (bars 56 to 64) is built on similar material to the second, but quite differently treated.

Final Section.—The final entries are slightly irregular. At the last semiquaver of bar 64 the subject enters in the treble, with its first note shortened and the following bar ornamented. A bar later the subject appears in the alto, making the closest stretto which the fugue contains, but its form also is varied, and it is abandoned at bar 68. On account of the stretti, neither the middle nor the final section employs the countersubject.

FUGUE 12

F MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

A remarkably fine fugue, rivalling No. 3 in the richness and variety of its episodes. It contains no stretto.

Exposition.—The subject